THE COMMIT BOOK

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Track and cross country, Class of 2029 edition. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27
NCAA Division I Manual.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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Track and cross country, Class of 2029 edition. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

> Education, not legal advice. No promise of an offer, aid or a roster spot. Confirm dates with each school's compliance office. `RECOMMENDED` = ours, not NCAA. `PROJECTED` = calculated, not yet published.

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1. YOUR MARKS ARE THE RESUME

Coaches look at verified marks on results sites, a steady improvement curve, consistency (a second-best mark near your PR) and how you place at state (coach guidance; r/CrossCountry D1 coach thread, 2016, paraphrased). Most events don't need video. You look up each program's recent conference results and roster marks yourself. We don't publish "standards"; they change every season.

2. WHEN CONTACT OPENS

WHAT OPENS	WHEN (CLASS OF 2029)	RULE
D1 calls, texts, emails	2027-06-15 (after sophomore year)	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1
D1 off-campus contact	2027-06-15	D1 Bylaw 13.1.1.1.9 (adopted 10/7/26)
D1 official visits	2027-08-01 (junior year)	D1 Bylaw 13.6.2.1.1 (rev. 10/7/26)
D1 athletics-involved unofficial visits	2027-08-01	D1 Bylaw 13.7.1.1
Recruiting talk at a D1 camp	2027-08-01	D1 Bylaw 13.12.1.5.1 (rev. 10/7/26)
Written aid offer	2028-08-01	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.1
Signing	`PROJECTED` 2028-11-08	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f)

New this cycle: the 10/7/26 change lets D1 track and cross country coaches meet you off campus from June 15 after sophomore year.

Roster caps at House-settlement D1 schools: cross country 17 per gender; indoor and outdoor track 45 per gender (D1 Bylaw 17.2).

3. THE DATED CALENDAR

DATE	TYPE	WHAT TO DO	RULE
2026-11-15	RECOMMENDED	Counselor course check	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1
Spring 2027	YOUR PLAN	Make sure every meet posts to a public results site	—
2027-06-15	OPENING	D1 calls, emails, off-campus contact. Send marks emails	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1, 13.1.1.1.9
2027-08-01	OPENING	D1 official and unofficial visits	D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.1, 13.7.1.1
2027-08-15	RECOMMENDED	Eligibility Center certification account	D1 Bylaw 13.6.3
2028-01-01	OPENING	D3 official visits	D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1
Before 7th semester	HARD	10/7 core courses	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b)
2028-08-01	OPENING	Written aid offers	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.1
2028-11-08	PROJECTED	Signing opens	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f)
Graduation	HARD	16 cores, 2.300 core GPA	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a)

4. TARGET LIST FROM MARKS

For each program: event group, last season's conference-final mark in your event, the roster's best mark in your event, seniors leaving in your event, your PR and your trend. Tiers: Reach (your PR below the roster's scorers), Fit (within range of conference scoring), Sure (you'd score now). Include D2, D3, NAIA, JUCO.

5. SCRIPTS

First email. Subject: `2029 | [Event] [PR] ([meet, date]) | [HS], [ST]`

> Coach [Last name], I'm [Name], Class of 2029 at [HS]. [Event]: PR [mark] at [meet, date], results link [link]. Progression: [9th] → [10th]. Next meets: [list]. GPA [x.x]. I'd like to know what you look for in your [event group]. [Name], [phone].

Answer every coach reply within 48 hours (recommended). Coaches report dropping athletes who don't respond.

6. TRACKERS

Marks tracker

DATE	MEET	EVENT	MARK	WIND/CONDITIONS	RESULTS LINK	PR?

Program fit

SCHOOL	DIV	CONF-FINAL MARK	ROSTER BEST	SENIORS LEAVING	MY PR	TIER

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual, LSDBi 90008, checked 2026-11-05: Bylaws 13.1.1.1.9, 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1, 13.6.2.1.1, 13.6.3, 13.7.1.1, 13.9.3.1, 13.12.1.5.1, 13.02.13.1(f), 14.3.1.1, 17.2.
- D3 Bylaw 13.6.1.1.1 as cited in site/data.js — TO VERIFY against current D3 printing.
- Coach guidance (paraphrased): r/CrossCountry D1 coach thread https://www.reddit.com/r/CrossCountry/comments/4v16xp/ (2016); USA Swimming-style progression guidance via Delta Aquatics. Advice, not rules.